difficulties which may be created by the Chinese support to Pakistan." Gromyko, however, was not willing to give something in return for nothing. He brought up the previously proposed bilateral treaty. Singh thought that might take too long. In the midst of the crisis, India needed some kind of "understanding" soon that could serve as a deterrent to China and Pakistan.[162] He subsequently asked Kosygin for a statement in support of India's territorial integrity and against any military attack, wanting Moscow to "neutralize" the possibility of Chinese intervention.[163]

To urge India toward a treaty or even a military cooperation agreement, Soviet officials, on their part, played up the Chinese threat. Grechko told Dhar not to worry about Pakistan as much as "the unpredictable enemy from the North," which was more likely to target India because India was "relatively militarily weak[er]" than the Soviet Union.[164]

To diversify its deterrence options, India sought reassurance from the US as well. In July, Indian defense minister Jagjivan Ram asked Kissinger about the US stance "in view of the present situation between [the US] and China, [the US] and Pakistan, and [the US], and Pakistan and China." Visiting India just before his trip to Beijing, the American national security adviser assured him that the US would take a very "grave view" of a Chinese move against India."[165] While it had not been invoked, the Air Defense Agreement remained on the books, and the US had continued to consider it as one of its military commitments in the Indian Ocean region. A contingency study in May had indeed noted that if there was an "unprovoked Chinese attack on India in support of Pakistan going beyond border incidents," the US would need to consider resuming military assistance and initiating consultations under the agreement.[166]

But Ram's question reflected Indian awareness of the changing US assessment of China. The Soviet chief of mission in London had told his Indian counterpart in March that the US was seeking an agreement with China.[167] When Kissinger met with Gandhi in Delhi that July, he also indicated that it was Nixon's policy to "gradually … establish a relationship with Communist China." He added that there "could be significant developments in the months ahead." They "were not directed at India," but due to the need to bring China into the international community.[168]

The prospect of rapprochement alone did not bother Indian officials, but doubts arose about its potential impact on US support for India. Haksar was